

options you can trudge across all the online repositories that host free design files for 3D printing. One of the key Google SketchUp resources that's included in the custom search option is the Timble Warehouse which hosts a lot of Google SketchUp files.

14. **GrabCAD** - If you're just interested in looking for free 3D designs then GrabCAD is the best resource on the web. However, its biggest limitation is that it caters to all sorts of CAD based designs that aren't always created with 3D printing in mind. For the adventurous and experimental out there, these free 3D designs can be used and converted for 3D printing if you know what you are doing. But with no clear tag management on the files it's hard to tell which files are suited for 3D printing. So don't stop with just the files that have the "3D printing" tag on it, since you may miss out on a lot of interesting free designs.

15. **i.materialise** - Of all the 3D printing service websites out there,



i.materialise even helps designers convert concepts into real objects with design and CAD professionals.

i.materialise has found great popularity in the press. The website provides the widest range of 3D printing services online but is not a good source of free designs. But if you are a creator who wishes to sell your designs across the world, then it's a great place to submit your material as they will help you host your own

store through their website where you can showcase and sell your work.

16. **Layer by Layer** - Designed to appeal to amateurs and home hobbyists who want access to simpler work files, LayerByLayer provides the solution. All the files on the website are "pre-sliced" for easy use with the popular Makerbot series of home printers. The website uses its own proprietary software called L2L that works as a printer manager. Certain limitations like its Makerbot-only files and lack of support for Unix based systems is still yet to be resolved.
17. **My Mini Factory** - One of the newest 3D printing service and resource website on the web, My Mini Factory is not actually an easy and free